STRAIT OF HORMUZ // EXECUTIVE SITREP

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LIVE DATA SNAPSHOT — PULLED 28 FEBRUARY 2026 | 19:01 EST

INDICATOR	LATEST VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	SOURCE
Brent Crude	**71.90** USD/bbl	2026-02-23	-$0.85 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
WTI Crude	**66.36** USD/bbl	2026-02-23	-$0.33 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
Heating Oil NY	**2.60** USD/gal	2026-02-23	+$0.11 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
Henry Hub Nat Gas (Monthly)	**7.72** USD/MMBtu	Jan 2026	+$3.46 vs Dec 2025	local-db (fred)
US Regular Gasoline	**2.94** USD/gal	2026-02-23	+$0.01 vs 2026-02-16	local-db (fred)
US Diesel (Retail)	**3.81** USD/gal	2026-02-23	+$0.10 vs 2026-02-16	local-db (fred)
US Crude Imports	**6,659** MBPD	2026-02-20	+135 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Exports	**4,313** MBPD	2026-02-20	-277 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Stocks	**435.8** MMbbl	2026-02-20	+16.0 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Production	**13,702** MBPD	2026-02-20	-33 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Gasoline Stocks	**254.8** MMbbl	2026-02-20	-1.0 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Distillate Stocks	**120.4** MMbbl	2026-02-20	+0.3 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Nat Gas Storage (Lower 48)	**2,018** Bcf	2026-02-20	-52 Bcf vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)

Green = fresh local data · Amber = stale — verify before use · Purple = synthetic test data · Stale thresholds: daily FRED 7d · weekly FRED 10d · EIA weekly 14d · monthly series 35d

0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime flows through the Strait of Hormuz remain stable, with ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, representing ~20% of globally traded petroleum. The most notable data move is the Henry Hub price, which has risen to $7.72/MMBtu, reflecting a seasonal demand spike. Brent is currently priced at $71.90/bbl, with a widening Brent-WTI spread at $5.54/bbl due to geopolitical risk premiums. Natural gas storage levels have decreased to 2,018 Bcf, indicating tightening supply. Risk bias: Stable operational posture; asymmetric upside disruption risk.

1 STRATEGIC OVERVIEW

The Strait of Hormuz remains a critical chokepoint, facilitating ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, which accounts for ~20% of globally traded petroleum. Key Gulf producers—Saudi Arabia, Iraq, UAE, Kuwait, and Iran—are heavily reliant on these flows for their export revenues. Current U.S. production stands at 13,702 MBPD, with exports at 4,313 MBPD, underscoring the U.S.'s role in global supply dynamics. Regional geopolitical volatility preserves asymmetric disruption risk.

2 OPERATIONAL ENVIRONMENT

The operational environment is stable, with a consistent presence of U.S. 5th Fleet assets ensuring maritime security. The IRGCN presence sustains latent escalation potential, maintaining a watchful eye on U.S. naval operations. Coalition Maritime Forces (CMF) continue to conduct routine patrols, reinforcing deterrence in the region.

3 COMMERCIAL SHIPPING & ENERGY MARKET INDICATORS

The largest absolute move is in Henry Hub, which has increased by $3.46 to $7.72/MMBtu, driven by seasonal demand factors and not directly linked to Gulf maritime flows. Brent is currently priced at $71.90/bbl, reflecting a slight decline of $0.85 since February 20, 2026, while the Brent-WTI spread has widened to $5.54/bbl, indicating elevated geopolitical risk premiums. WTI is priced at $66.36/bbl, maintaining a stable market position.

4 72-HOUR WATCHPOINTS

Key watchpoints include Brent breaking above approximately +5% from the current $71.90/bbl, Henry Hub exceeding $8.00/MMBtu, and any significant military engagement or escalation involving Iranian forces in the Strait of Hormuz that could disrupt maritime flows.

 Market data sourced from local storeroom (EIA/FRED observations). Distribution: ADM